

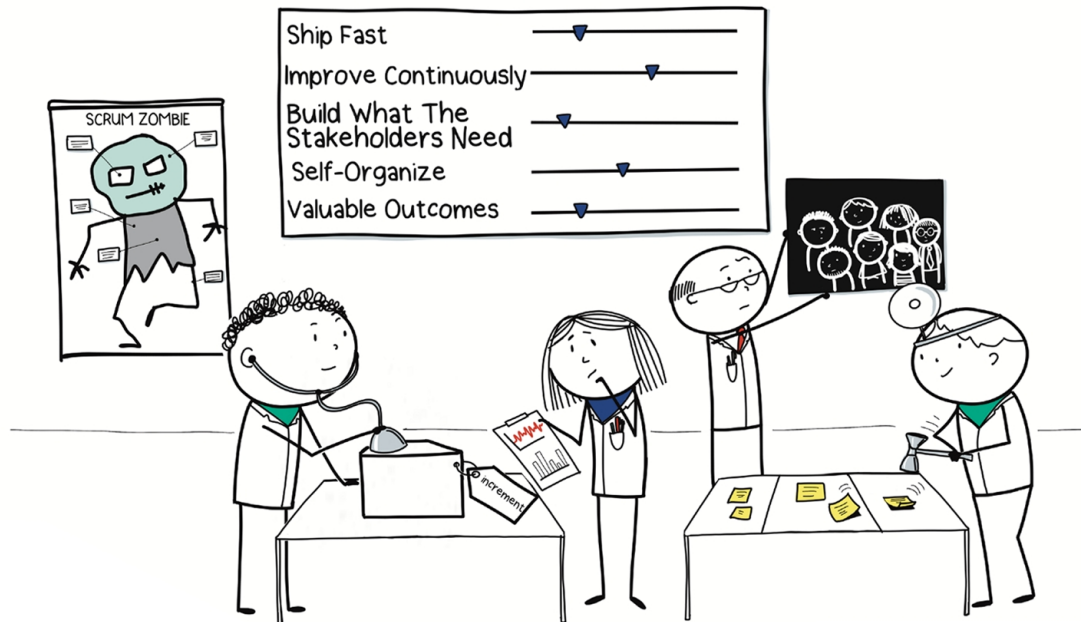
Start A Book Club To Learn Together

A simple experiment to draw in new ideas from new sources and spur innovation



Start A Book Club to Learn Together

It takes creativity and out-of-the-box thinking to solve the many hard challenges we face when trying to work empirically. Thankfully, books, blog posts, and podcasts are a great source for new ideas and inspiration. This experiment is all about drawing in new ideas from new sources to spur innovation.



Created by Thea Schukken for the Zombie Scrum Survival Guide
by Christiaan Verwijs, Johannes Schartau & Barry Overeem
zombiescrum.org

Difficulty / Effort

Required Skill



Starting this initiative is easy. Turning it into a recurring event requires some perseverance.

Impact On Survival



Creating a culture where people actively seek out new ideas and possibilities is a major ingredient in overcoming Zombie Scrum.

Steps

To implement this experiment, do the following:

1. Pick a book, a blog post, or a podcast to start with. See some recommendations below. We offer some suggestions below.
2. Invite people in a way that emphasizes that participation is optional. Don't make people feel bad when they don't join. It works better to have one or two intrinsically motivated members than a whole group of people who don't really want to be there.
3. Pick a date for the first gathering **60 min**. Schedule a time during work hours; learning also works. Distribute copies of the book, the blog post, or the podcast. Ask people to prepare by reading the blog post, listen to the podcast, or read (part of) the book.
4. Open the first gathering by clarifying the purpose; to gather useful insights and novel ideas from reading books, blog posts, and listening to podcasts.
5. First individually, ask people to make a list of their personal takeaways. Ask: "What was surprising, exciting, or insightful to you?". Invite people to share and build on their insights, first in pairs **2 min** than with another pair **4 min**. Collect big takeaways from the whole group **10 min**.
6. First individually, ask people to consider how this might benefit them or their team. Ask: "What applications or uses do you see that might benefit you or our team? ". Invite people to share and build on their insights, first in pairs **2 min** than with another pair **4 min**. Collect applications with potential from the whole group **10 min**.
7. Use "[15% Solutions](#)" to translate the most promising application(s) into tangible, individual actions.
8. Schedule a new gathering.



Our Findings



- Make the decision of what to read a joint decision of the group.
- Resist the temptation to cancel or postpone this gathering in favor of getting more work done. Building a learning culture takes time and persistence.

More Resources



- The podcast "[Agile for Humans](#)" by Ryan Ripley.
- The book "[The Phoenix Project](#)" by Gene Kim, Kevin Behr, and George Spafford.
- With developers, read "[Clean Code](#)" by Robert C. Martin. Or "[The Pragmatic Programmer](#)" by Andrew Hunt.
- The podcast "[The Scrum Master Toolbox](#)" by Vasco Duarte.
- Blog posts by people like [Gunther Verheyen](#), [John Cutler](#), [Geoff Watts](#), [Roman Pichler](#) or [Stephanie Ockerman](#).
- Novel ideas often come from unexpected sources. Don't be afraid to venture beyond the domain of product development by exploring books about economics, organizational design, autobiographies, and psychology. For example, books like [Images of Organization](#), [Social Physics](#), [Black Swan](#), and [Bullshit Jobs](#) are not directly about software- or product development, but there are many meaningful insights to distill from them.
- We feel self-conscious about plugging our own content, but we hope [our podcast](#) (50+ episodes) and [blog](#) (250+ articles) also offer value.
- This [whitepaper about the purpose of the Scrum Framework](#) is a good way to refresh what it is all about.

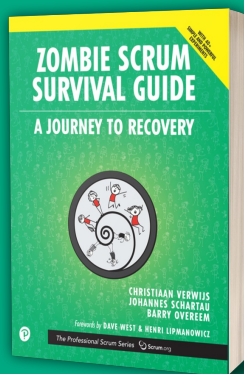
Help Us With Your Feedback



We are eager to learn how this experiment benefitted your team. What did it make possible? How did it help you make progress in your recovery from Zombie Scrum? With your data, we can improve our recommendations to other teams. You can share [your feedback](#) here with us in a only few minutes.



The Zombie Scrum Survival Guide



Zombie Scrum is on the rise! What may look like Scrum from a distance often turns out to be anything but when you take a closer look. Although teams go through the motions of Scrum, Sprints don't result in valuable outcomes, customers are not involved, teams have little autonomy and nobody is doing anything to improve.

A detailed examination of Zombie Scrum

In our book, we share our research and experience in the field with Zombie Scrum. We explore symptoms and causes, and dig deep into why Zombie Scrum usually starts when the purpose of Scrum isn't clear. With our book, the purpose of Scrum was never this clear!

Start your recovery tomorrow

The good news is that recovery is entirely possible. Our book contains over 40 practical experiments to start recovery, even when your organization has succumbed to it completely.

Get your copy now

You can find the 'Zombie Scrum Survival Guide' in your favorite bookstore starting from November 23, 2020. Or buy your copy from us at zombiescrum.org. The book comes with a free digital first aid kit, and a nice discount for a physical kit.



The Zombie Scrum Resistance

The 'Zombie Scrum Survival Guide' is written by Christiaan Verwijns, Johannes Schartau and Barry Overeem, and richly illustrated by Thea Schukken.

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